



What Is News

When a dog bites a man that is not news, but when a man bites a dog that is news. *Charles Anderson Dana, American journalist,*

News is what somebody somewhere wants to suppress; all the rest is advertising. *Lord Northcliffe, British publisher*

Well, news is anything that's interesting, that relates to what's happening in the world, what's happening in areas of the culture that would be of interest to your audience.

News according to different authors

William G. Bleyer defines it like this:

- News is anything timely that interests a number of people; and the best news is that which has the greatest interest for the greatest number.

William S. Maulsby defined news thus:

- News is an accurate, unbiased account of the significant facts of a timely happening that is of interest to the readers of the newspaper that prints the account.

Mitchel Chainley defined news as:

- The timely report of facts or opinions that hold interest of importance, or both for a considerable number of people.

Elements of news

Timeliness

News is something new . Current news has more **impact** than something that happened yesterday or last week. The public and news media lose interest quickly, and past events become stale when there's always fresh news somewhere. So timeliness is great factor in deciding news .An incident that happened one month back will not make news for today's newspaper. Also timeliness varies from publication to publication. For a newspaper, event that happened on the previous day is news. But for a weekly , events of the previous one week can make a news. For a 24 news hour channel, every second is deadline. They can break the news anytime. So their timeliness is different from that of a newspaper.

Proximity

Location, location, location: If an event is happening nearby, it will impact the audience more than if it were happening somewhere else that doesn't affect them as much, such as in another state or country. For example, if the local high school football team is going to the state championship, or if music star Rahat Fateh ali Khan is coming to town to perform, residents will want to know about it. Similarly, if your company is opening a location in a new state, your company becomes more relevant to people there.

Prominence



A well-known person, place, or event has a stronger news angle than something the audience isn't familiar with. A guest speaker visiting your local elementary school to take over story time doesn't resonate with many people... unless that speaker is public figure or famous personality e.g celebrities' influencers , politicians.

Oddity

If something is unusual, shocking, or bizarre, the strangeness and novelty alone could make it newsworthy. Extraordinary and unexpected things generate public interest. You might have seen box items in newspapers about such happenings e.g A man pulls a car by his hair , a women gives birth to triplets a singer enter the Guinness book by singing non stop for 24 hours or a painting of a famous artist is auctioned for a very expensive price. All such odd stories evoke public interest.

Currency

News is about current events . Suppose the Olympic games are held in Japan . It becomes news because everyone is interested in it. Likewise SCO meeting 2024 held in Pakistan to formulate future action plans it becomes the current news. Similarly if extreme cold weather continues for a week and fog disrupts air, rail and road traffic it becomes news.

Impact

Impact of an event decides the newsworthiness. When the tsunami waves struck several parts of the world , thousands of people were affected . It became major news for the whole world. But if a cyclone kills 20 people in Bangladesh it may not have any impact on parts of the world but when dengue killed 100 people in Lahore it makes news not only in Lahore but in other provinces also because the impact is more wide and people become more alert about the news.

Conflict

Audiences are always interested in disagreements, arguments, and rivalries. If an event creates conflict, many consumers will be interested based on that alone. Let's not forget that it's human nature to choose sides and stand up for their opinions, views, and preferences. Conflict news stories include religion, politics, legal disputes, sports, business, trials, wars, human rights violations, politics, and even struggles against nature, animals, and outer space.

Human interest

If a situation draws an emotional reaction, it might contain the news element of a human-interest story. These can be soft news, For example the police rescued a school boy kidnapped by mischief makers after a search of two weeks and parents meet the boy in an emotionally surcharged atmosphere. The story of his meeting with a photograph makes a good human interest report .